

Food preservation myth busters

Category	Myth busting - Discussion - Table engagement
Skill level	Beginner to run - the answer and a plain-language "bust" are on every card and the tablet. Great for conversation; lean on the Volunteer key for the deeper science.
Audience	Teens & Adults. The myths sound plausible and the busts get into real food-safety reasoning, so it suits older players.
Setup time	5-10 minutes

DESCRIPTION

A visitor reads a plausible-sounding preservation claim and guesses TRUE or FALSE - then you flip the card (or tap the tablet) to bust it with a warm, plain-language explanation, why people believe it, and a risk level. Most myths are FALSE, with a few surprising TRUEs. 40 cards across 8 topics; HIGH-risk myths are marked with a red border.

MATERIALS NEEDED

Digital version (tablet)

- A tablet open to the game: sign in to the MFP Volunteer Resource Hub, tap "Outreach," then "Play on tablet" on the Food preservation myth busters card.

Printed version (no technology needed)

- The cards printed double-sided: "myth-cards-front.pdf" (the claim) on the front and "myth-cards-back.pdf" (TRUE/FALSE + the bust) on the back. HIGH-risk myths have a red border.
- The "Volunteer key" (volunteer-key.pdf) - every myth with the answer, the bust, why people believe it, the real science, the risk level, and the source.

Both versions

- Table, tablecloth, and MFP / OSU Extension signage; optional take-home educational handouts.
- This Activity guide on the table.

SETUP

1. Decide digital, printed cards, or both.
2. Printed: print the cards double-sided (flip on the SHORT edge so the bust lands on the back) and cut. Print the Volunteer key and keep it next to you.
3. Digital: charge the tablet, open the game, and try one myth.

ACTIVITY DIRECTIONS

Running it

1. Read the myth out loud (or let the visitor read it) and ask: TRUE or FALSE?
2. Let them commit to a guess - that is what makes the reveal land.
3. Flip the card (or tap their choice on the tablet) to reveal the answer and the bust.
4. Read the bust warmly and mention why people believe it. Point out the risk level, especially for HIGH-risk myths.
5. Refer deeper "why" questions to the Volunteer key or a Master Food Preserver, then move on.

VOLUNTEER NOTES

- Keep the Volunteer key next to you - it has the answer, the bust, and the deeper science for every myth.
- Tone matters: be warm and non-judgmental. Many myths come from old cookbooks or family tradition; the goal is to update gently, not to embarrass.
- Accuracy matters: read the answer and bust as written; do not improvise. Refer harder questions to a Master Food Preserver.
- The HIGH-risk myths are the most important to bust clearly - those are the ones that can actually make someone sick.
- A few myths are TRUE on purpose (things people doubt but are correct) - lean into the surprise.
- No tablet? The printed cards play exactly the same.
- There are no prizes - the "aha" and the conversation are the point.